



EMPOWER Labs

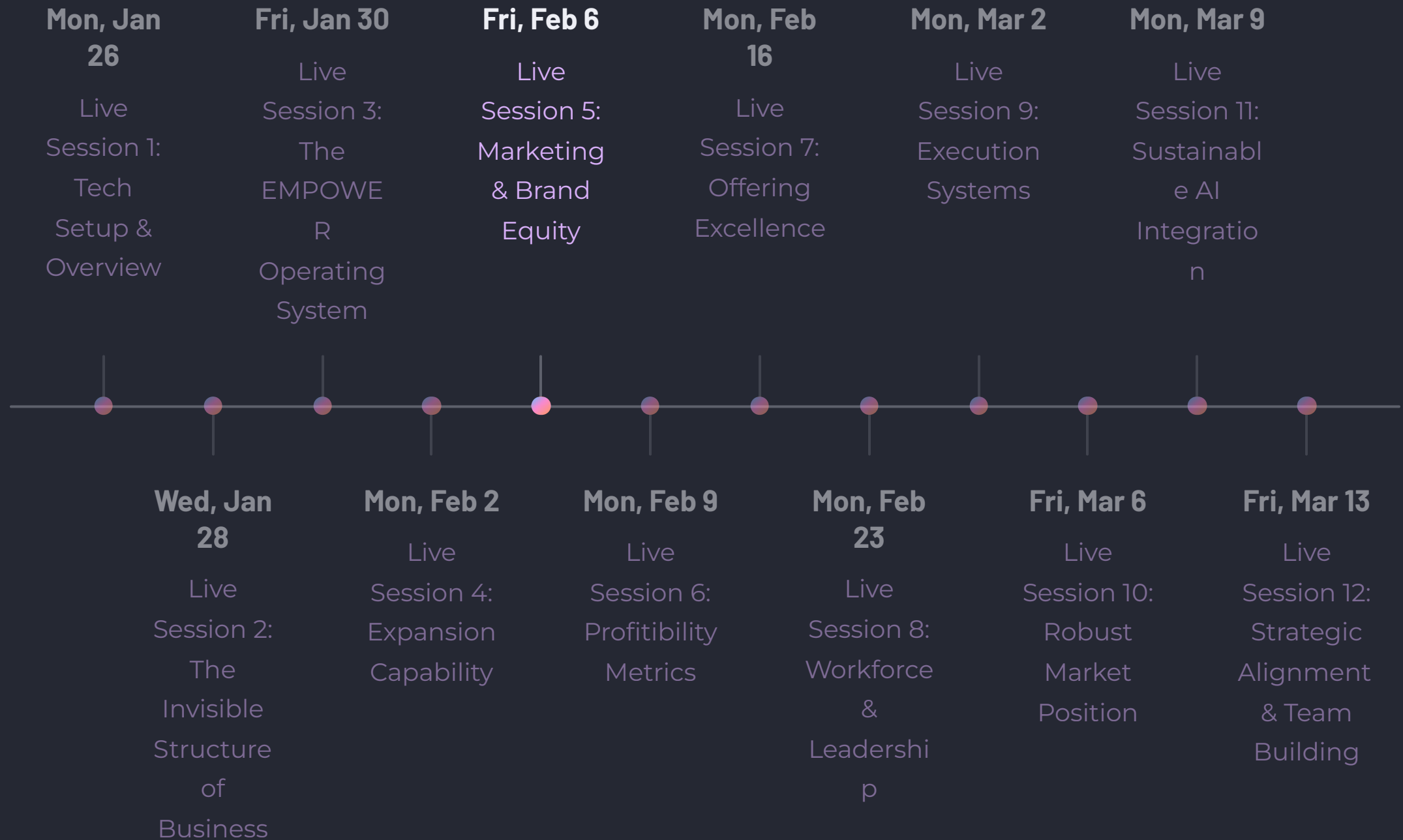
Session 5: Marketing & Brand Equity

Today, we focus on the engine that drives customer acquisition.

We'll explore how **marketing directly impacts business valuation** through:

- Predictable revenue generation
- Reduced customer acquisition costs
- Brand asset value
- Scalable growth systems

Program Timeline



The 6 Stages of the Customer Lifecycle (Core Processes)



Milestones: Where You Should Be at This Point

-  Added the 5 Rs to Your Master Prompt
-  Ran the Assessment (Delivery to Success)
-  Mapped Out Your Customer Journey & Ascension Points
-  Created the Level 1 & 2 SOP (Delivery to Success)
-  Created Your Priority Implementation Matrix v.1
-  Started Organizing Your SOPs

 **Poll:** Have you completed the exercises up until this session?

What You'll Get Out of This Session



1. Your Unique
Value
Proposition

2. The 4 Basic
Units of
Marketing
Economics

3. The 4
Channels of
Customer
Acquisition



Part 1: Crafting Your Unique Value Proposition (UVP)

Becoming a Category of One

You're so uniquely positioned that direct comparison becomes impossible, allowing you to increase prices.

Traditional Differentiation vs. Category of One

- **Traditional:** "We're better, faster, cheaper."
- **Category of One:** "We're the only ones who..."



The Disruption Imperative

- Constantly **disrupt yourself** before others do
- Ask: "If I were starting this business today with AI, **what would I do differently?**"
- Your biggest threat isn't current competitors – it's **someone who hasn't started yet**



Building Your Moat in a Post-AI world

01
10

Unique Data + AI Processing

Combine your proprietary customer data with AI insights



Human Personal Brand

People care about people. We still watch chess.



Community and Connection

This will become more important than ever.
Curation of community will become ultra-niche.



The AI Acceleration Effect

1

AI democratizes execution – your competitors will soon all be able to execute as well as you

2

Competition will come faster and cheaper than ever before

3

If you don't have a moat, you'll compete purely on price

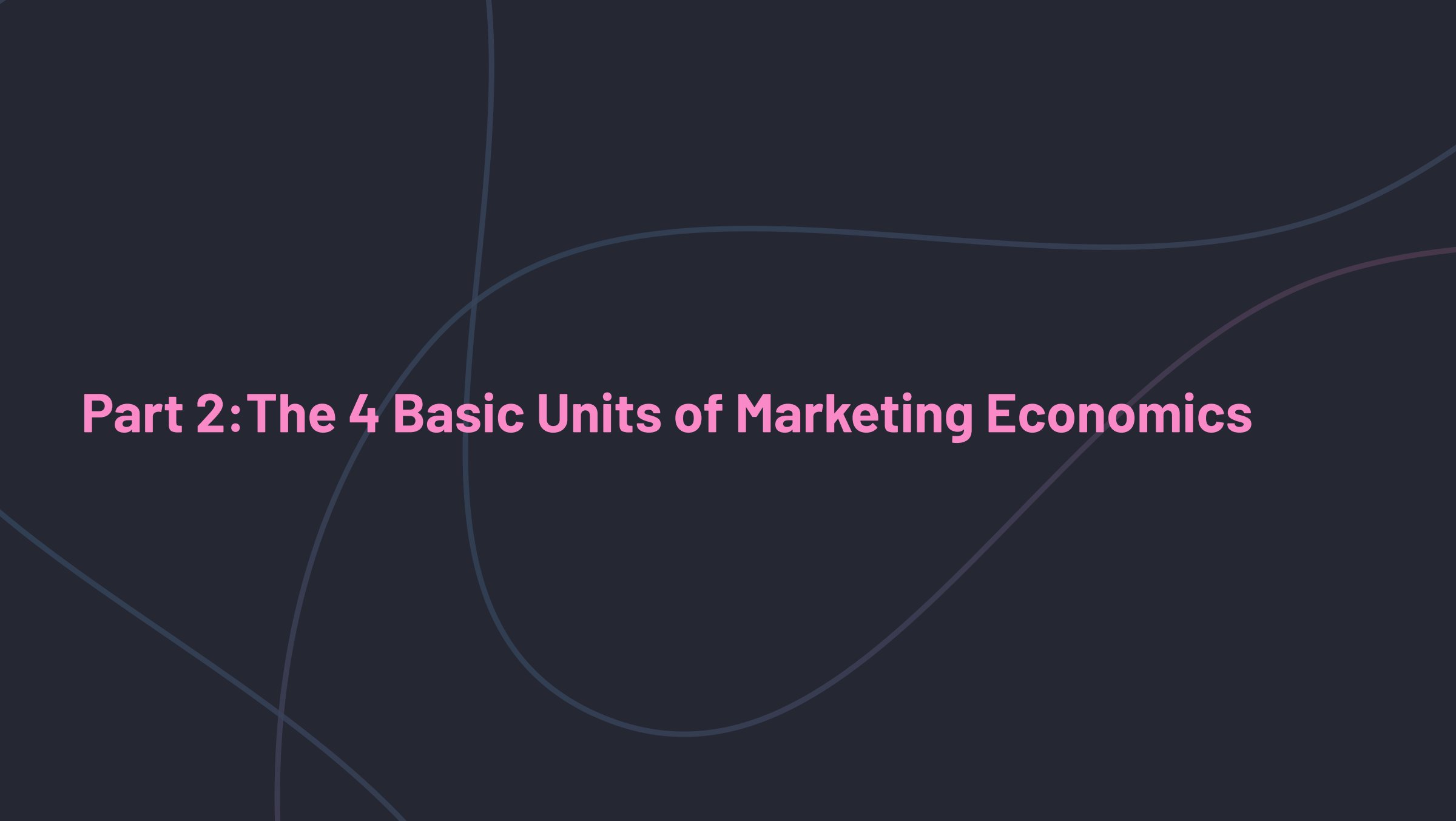


Breakout Discussion

Take 15 minutes in groups of 3-4 to discuss:

What would it look like for your company to become a "Category of One"?





Part 2: The 4 Basic Units of Marketing Economics

What Are Unit Economics?

1 Unit Economics = The financial performance of ONE unit (customer, transaction, product, etc.)

- How much does it cost to acquire a customer?
- How much profit do they generate?
- How long does it take to recover our investment?

2 Why This Matters

- Determines if your business model works
- Guides marketing spend decisions
- Shows which channels to scale



1. Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)

CAC = Variable Marketing Costs ÷ New Customers

Example

\$8,000 variable costs ÷ 40 customers = \$200 CAC

Include

- Ad spend
- Campaign costs

Exclude

- Fixed salaries
- Software subscriptions
- Office overhead

Why Variable-Only CAC Matters

Wrong Way

\$10,000 ads + \$5,000 salary + \$1,000 software = \$400 CAC

Right Way

\$10,000 ads = \$300 CAC

The Difference

Fixed costs are recovered through volume, not per-customer

2. 90-Day Customer Value

90-Day Value = Revenue - COGS - Sales Commissions

Example

\$2,500 revenue - \$500 COGS - \$250 commission = \$1,750 value

Why 90 Days

- More accurate than lifetime value
- Better for cash flow planning
- Avoids inflated projections



3. The Golden Ratio

Customer Value ÷ CAC = Success Metric

Example

$\$1,750 \div \$300 = 5.8:1 = \text{Great}$

Benchmarks

- 10:1+ = Excellent (Scale aggressively)
- 5-10:1 = Great (Strong growth)
- 3-5:1 = Good (Profitable)
- 2-3:1 = Danger (Optimize now)
- <2:1 = Critical (Losing money)



4. Payback Period

Breakeven Analysis

**Breakeven = Fixed Costs ÷
Contribution Margin**

**Contribution Margin =
Customer Value - CAC**

Example

Fixed costs: \$25,000/month

Contribution: \$1,750 - \$300 =
\$1,450

Breakeven: 18
customers/month

Payback Period

**Payback = CAC ÷ Monthly
Gross Profit**

Benchmarks

- 1-3 months = Excellent
- 3-6 months = Good
- 6+ months = Risky

Example

\$300 CAC ÷ \$150 monthly profit
= 2 months



Your Action Plan

1 Calculate These 4 Numbers

- CAC (variable costs only)
- 90-Day Customer Value
- Golden Ratio (aim for 3:1+)
- Payback Period (incl. Breakeven Point)

2 Watch for Red Flags

- CAC increasing
- 90-Day Customer Value decreasing
- Missing breakeven

3 Next Steps

Track monthly, then optimize worst channels first

Why Unit Economics Break Down: The Commoditization Trap

When you're not differentiated:

1

CAC increases

You compete on price and need more touches to convert

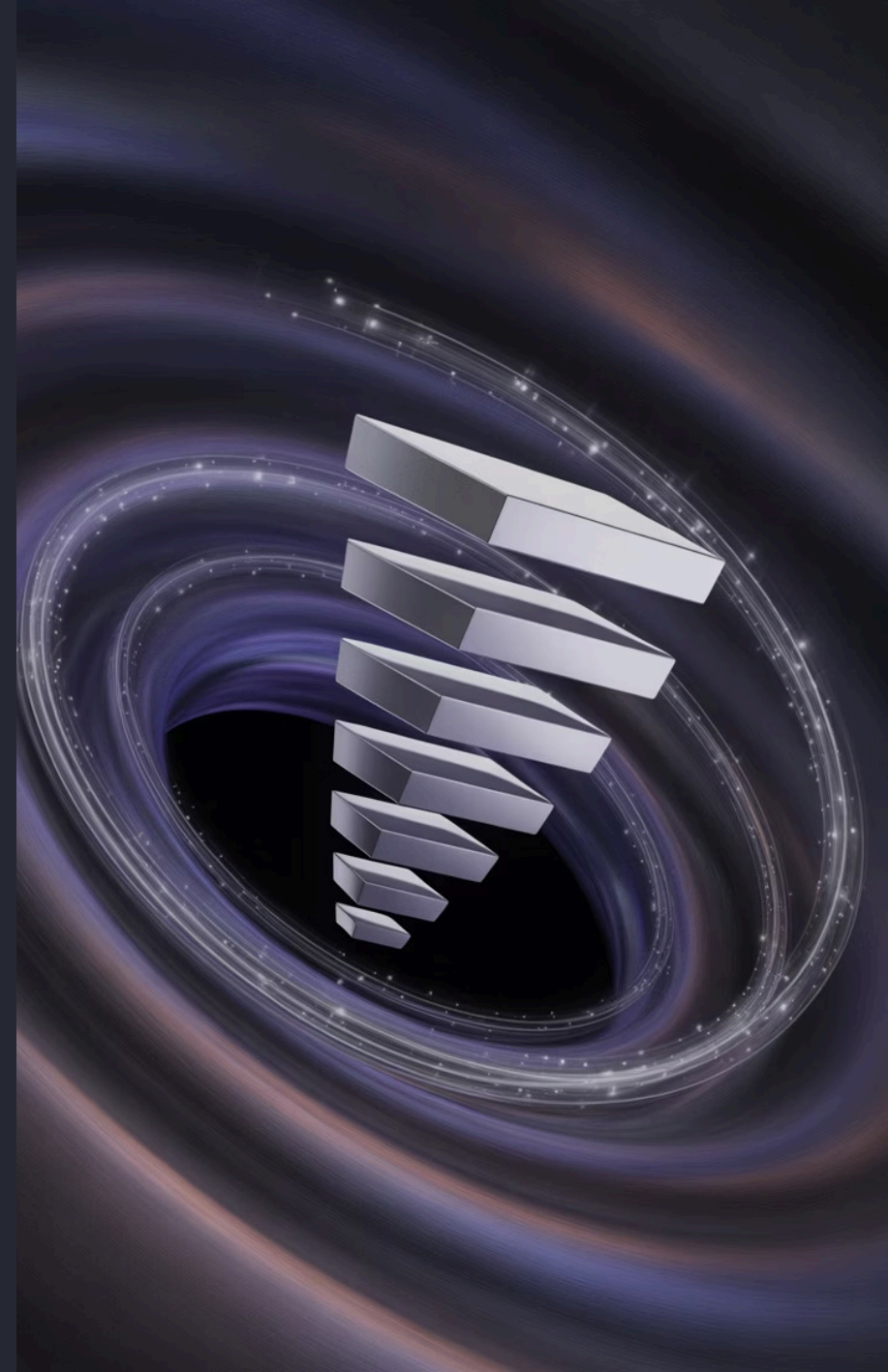
2

Customer value decreases

Price pressure reduces margins

3

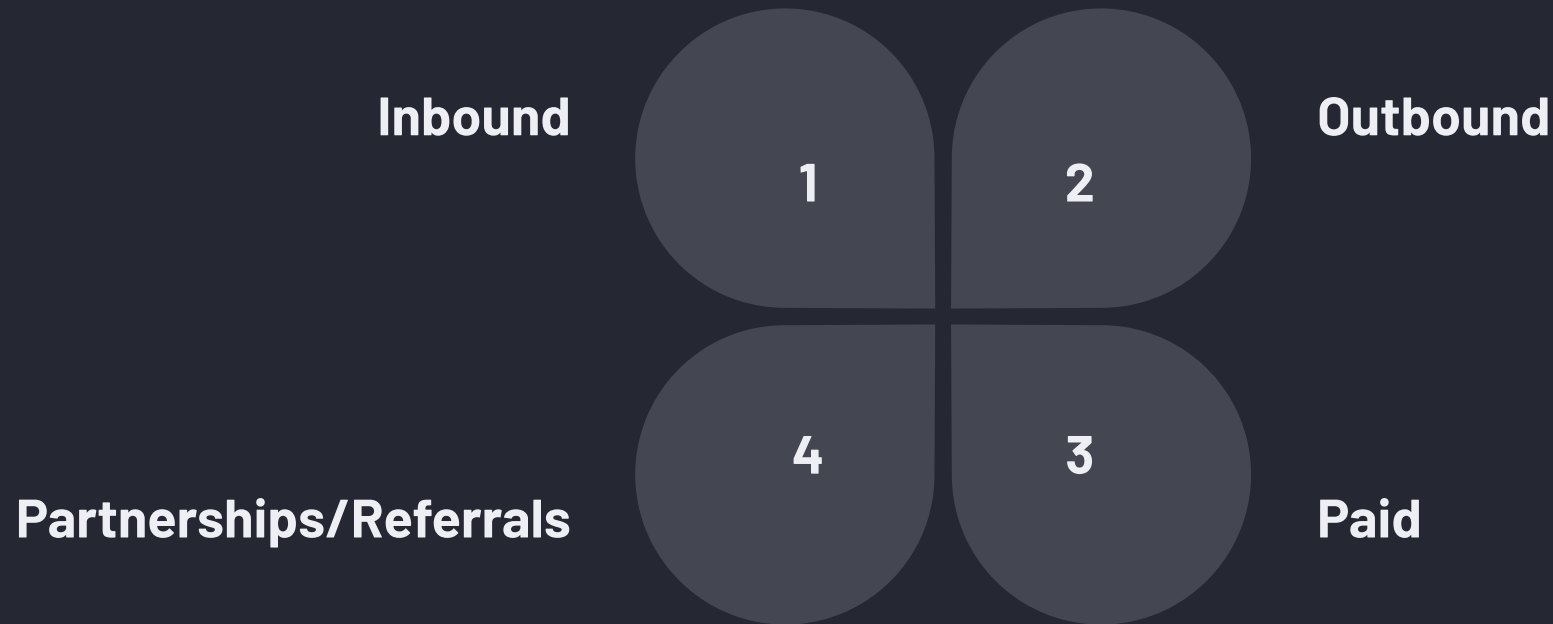
You're trapped in a race to the bottom





Part 3: The 4 Channels for Customer Acquisition

The 4 Channels for Customer Acquisition





All Available Marketing Channels

	1 to 1	1 to Many
Inbound	Comment replies, DMs	Blog posts, YouTube, podcasts, case studies, SEO
Outbound	Cold emails, LinkedIn DMs, cold calls	Mass cold outreach, LinkedIn sequences
Paid	Retargeting ads, 1:1 funnel invites	Facebook/Google ads, sponsored content
Partnership/referral	Intro emails, custom pitches	Affiliate campaigns, partner webinars



1. Inbound (1 to Many)

The most AI-leveraged channel

How

AI generates blog posts, videos, newsletters, SEO-optimized pages, etc.

Why

It gives you high leverage via content repurposing and mass distribution

Example

One interactive prompt → 1 long-form blog post, 10 tweets, 2 YouTube scripts, 2 newsletters



2. Outbound (1 to Many)

Personalized outreach at scale

How

AI writes and personalizes cold email sequences at scale

Why

AI can analyze ideal customer data, generate A/B testing messages, and automate follow-ups

Example

10,000 hyper-personalized cold emails per week

Example: Hyper-Personalized Cold Emails

1

Build a list

Apify.com

2

Enrich the list

Clay.com

3

Draft email template

Claude

4

Add a custom video

SendPotion or HeyGen

5

Send the emails

Smartlead.ai

6

Automate replies

RevReply.com



Examples of 4 Levels of Marketing SOPs at Acquia

1

Level 1: Core Process

- Level 1: Market to Lead - Accelerator

2

Level 2: Blueprints

- **Level 2: Inbound Marketing Blueprint** 🙌
- Level 2: Outbound Marketing Blueprint
- Level 2: Paid Advertising Blueprint
- Level 2: Partnership/Referral Blueprint

3

Level 3: Guides

- **Level 3: Blog Content Creation Guide** 🙌
- Level 3: YouTube Video Production Guide
- Level 3: Lead Magnet Development Guide
- Level 3: Email Nurture Sequence Guide

4

Level 4: Tools

- Level 4: Blog Post Template (Acquisition Strategy)
- Level 4: SEO Keyword Research Form
- Level 4: Content Calendar Template
- Level 4: Blog Post Promotion Checklist

Q&A

Your turn to ask your questions.



Your Next Steps

01

Research Your Competitors (Optional)

Get a comprehensive understanding of your main competitors' positioning

02

Run the Assessment (Market to Lead)

Assess your organization's performance, gauge the dependence on the owner, and identify areas for improvement

03

Craft Your UVP v1

Get clear on how you differentiate yourself in the market

04

Analyze Your Unit Economics (Fractional CRO)

Understand the performance of your marketing channels and optimize your customer acquisition strategy

05

Create the Level 1 & 2 SOP (Market to Lead)

Create a map of the core process (Level 1) as well as blueprints for each functional area within the process (Level 2)

06

Draft Inbound Content Marketing Material (Optional)

Discover how effective Claude can be in creating diverse marketing material for your business

Live Session 6: Profitability Metrics

Monday, February 9th at 10 am PT / 1 pm ET

